

of the line flagship from a global giant, or a cheap Chinese knock-off, they're both being sold with some ridiculous spec of slow-mo being advertised. What's worse, some of the phones market it as a hero feature, and they turn out to not be too great at it anyway. A terrible video shot with a terrible camera, in slow motion, is torture! Besides, it's something you will probably rarely use, and will tire of pretty quickly. There's only so many slow moving shots of your dog or baby that people will look at before they unfriend you. Instead, look at reviews and look for a camera that has better low light performance, or offers bokeh effects in portrait mode, or something you will actually use more than six times. We call BS, but it's hardly the worst offense here, so it's just a lonely, solitary turd for this feature.

BIOMETRIC SECURITY



We love fingerprint readers, because they're accurate, fast, secure enough, and were pretty simple to use. Then came all the design changes, and the fingerprint scanner got relegated to something on the back of the phone. This is when the problems started. To us, it feels like all these fancy face readers and iris scanners came along



So Futuristic!

as a way of getting you to forget that your trusty fingerprint reader was now impossible to find. But aren't face detectors and iris scanners harder to bypass than fingerprints? Actually, no. Security researchers have demonstrated various ways of bypassing these biometric security measures using something as simple as a printout, to more elaborate hacks that involve



Consumers neither need to nor want to know about special smartphone polishing mixtures

3D printing. No current biometric authentication system in the world is 100 percent accurate. In fact, you're probably compromising your security by jumping on to the newest methods without letting them mature first. Even fingerprints can be hacked by what's called a smudge attack, which can often also reveal your passcode or pattern unlock. Fingerprints are still considered more secure than others though, especially when linking to a store for purchase confirmations. But why are we giving biometrics four turds? Because once your security is compromised, it's forever compromised. What are you going to do?

Change your fingerprints or your face? You could change a pass code though... just saying.

18:9



This one is a five turd winner! How do you show that your new screen has a greater aspect ratio than 16:9? Why, call it 18:9 of course, and let's all forget that it actu-

ally equals 2:1, because math sucks and marketing rocks! Let's not even start the whole "there's no content for this stupid aspect ratio" rant. Add to this the fact that some phones say 18:9 but are more like 18.5: 9, which would actually make them 37:18 phones... but who would ever remember that, so instead just pretend the extra .5 screen ratio doesn't exist... Shh!

DESIGN



Most of those turds should belong to Apple. They're the ones who keep going ga-ga over design, which results in everyone else copying them.

Let's forget for a moment that in technology good design is usually something that is invisible. If it is so good, you don't need to scream it from the rooftops, we'll figure it out, thank you. What *really* lights our farts are the wild claims. Next we're going to be told that the ashes of dead fairies was added to pure moon dust in order to polish the back of your smartphone, in factories where little Chinese children work their fingers to the bone for you... OK that last bit might actually be true...

Anyway, let's say you're the type to be impressed by the fancy names companies give to what's essentially plastic or aluminium, and you decide to spend the better part of a lakh on the latest and greatest flagship phone that was designed just for you in a whiter than white toilet that some guy called Ive calls home. You wait in line, kissing the pavement outside your favourite company's shop, get the device, show it off on social media, and then realise that the super smooth metal and curved edges make the darn thing slippery and drop it just a few hours in. No? You're too smart for that? So you probably paid 70k for a phone that charged you at least 10k premium for the design, only to immediately buy a case that promptly makes all of the design totally pointless. Are you sure you're the smarter one?